



A national laboratory where samples from suspected Ebola cases are tested on Tuesday in Goma, Democratic Republic of Congo.

Guard Killed At a Mosque Called a Hero

This article is by Christina Morales, Jill Cowan and Tim Arango.

Every morning, before he headed to work across town as a security guard at the Islamic Center of San Diego, Amin Abdullah would arrive at a tiny, worn-down mosque.

Just as he would at his job, he would sweep the perimeter, using a flashlight to check every corner. And then he would go inside and pray, a friend, Khalid Alexander, said.

Mr. Abdullah, who was a Muslim convert, felt he had a calling as a security guard at the Islamic Center after he was pained by the 2019 terrorist attack against the Muslim community in Christchurch, New Zealand.

On Monday, Mr. Abdullah was killed in service of that calling, protecting the children inside the Islamic Center when terror arrived at its door.

The authorities said Mr. Abdullah and two other members of the Islamic Center community were shot and killed on Monday by two teenagers who later killed themselves in a vehicle blocks away. The killings at the mosque were being investigated as a hate crime and set off new concerns of Islamophobia in the United States.

The attack began when both suspects ran past Mr. Abdullah, the security guard, to get into the Islamic Center, and they likely did not see him there initially, Chief Scott Wahl of the San Diego Police Department said at a news conference on Tuesday. Once Mr. Abdullah saw the gunmen, he quickly reached for his radio and ordered a lockdown. Then, he shot at both gunmen.

The gunmen returned fire at Mr. Abdullah, and Chief Wahl said that he “continued to engage in a gun battle with the two suspects.”

“His actions — without a doubt — delayed, distracted and ultimately deterred these two individuals from gaining access to the greater areas of the mosque, where as many as 140 kids were within 15 feet of these suspects,” Chief Wahl said. “Tragically, he died in that gun battle.”

While the police in San Diego have not publicly named either suspect, two law enforcement officials briefed on the matter identified the teenagers as Cain Clark, 17, and Caleb Vazquez, 18. The teenagers, both from San Diego,

Continued on Page A21

Ebola Raged in Congo for Weeks Before Alarm

By RUTH MACLEAN

DAKAR, Senegal — As soon as Ebola was identified in the Democratic Republic of Congo and Uganda late last week, the severity of the outbreak was clear. There were already hundreds of suspected cases and dozens of suspected deaths.

Shortly after the outbreak was announced, the World Health Organization declared it a global health emergency.

But by then, the virus had already been circulating for weeks.

Congo has surveillance systems meant to identify outbreaks early so that they can be effec-

Early Safeguards Didn’t Identify Rare Species of the Virus

tively contained. The country has added several laboratories in recent years and has extensive experience with previous, devastating Ebola outbreaks.

And yet, precious time was lost when officials in Ituri, the province at the heart of the current outbreak, did not raise the alarm when patients began to show symptoms. Samples may not have been sent quickly enough to Kin-

shasa, the capital, for testing.

“The alert was out very late,” said Dr. Marie-Roseline Belizaire, a doctor and epidemiologist who is leading the W.H.O. response to the outbreak.

The consequences of such a long delay could prove catastrophic. There are no vaccines or treatments for Ebola Bundibugyo, the rare species of the virus that is responsible for the current outbreak.

Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus, the director-general of the W.H.O., said at a meeting in Geneva on Tuesday that he was “deeply concerned” about the scale and speed of the outbreak, shortly after Con-

Continued on Page A10

Staying Silent, Trump’s in Bind On Abortion Pill

By PAM BELLUCK and SHERYL GAY STOLBERG

With the midterm elections less than six months away, Republicans are facing challenging political headwinds, including an unpopular war, escalating inflation and President Trump’s sinking approval ratings. Now another issue is putting the administration in a political bind.

Abortion.

Four years after the Supreme Court overturned Roe v. Wade, which established a national right to abortion in 1973, abortion remains widely available, and the number per year has actually increased slightly. Much of that is because of the availability of abortion pills. The Food and Drug Administration has so far not walked away from a decision made during the Biden administration to allow access to the abortion pill mifepristone through the mail.

But a lawsuit against the F.D.A. now threatens that access, and the Trump administration has remained strikingly silent about it, even as the case reached the Supreme Court this month.

The suit, brought by the state of Louisiana, led a federal appeals court to temporarily bar a policy allowing abortion providers to prescribe mifepristone through

Continued on Page A19

PRIMARIES Results of Tuesday’s races in six states, including key battles in Kentucky and Georgia. Coverage at nytimes.com.



APU GOMES/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE — GETTY IMAGES

Fire Unsettles Southern California

Thousands were under evacuation orders with wind-driven blazes threatening suburban homes.

Political Money Takes Murky Trail to Influencers

By KEN BENSINGER

Last month, Carlos Eduardo Espina, a progressive influencer, revealed a surprising endorsement to his 14.5 million followers on TikTok: He would support Tom Steyer, the billionaire running for California governor as a Democrat.

“I really believe Tom Steyer is different,” Mr. Espina said in a speech that he posted on social media. “He could be traveling around the world or doing what-

Endorsements Slide by Disclosure Rules

ever he wants, but he wants to serve the people of this state.”

Unmentioned in Mr. Espina’s post: Mr. Steyer’s campaign was paying him \$100,000 to help win the election.

A few days earlier, Mr. Espina, who lives in Texas, had noted in a video that the campaign hired him

to consult on issues related to Latinos, which are the primary focus of Mr. Espina’s social media posts. But none of his several dozen subsequent posts on TikTok, Instagram or Threads promoting Mr. Steyer noted the financial arrangement.

The \$100,000 fee, buried in campaign finance records, is described as a payment for “strategic advice and campaign surrogacy.” The money went to a limited liability company in Texas

Continued on Page A15

BUSINESS B1-6

Challenges for Tech Titans

The collapse of Elon Musk’s lawsuit against OpenAI and Sam Altman will speed up the artificial intelligence juggernaut even as public opposition to it is growing. News Analysis. PAGE B1

New Fee for Electric Vehicles

Congress may require owners of electric vehicles and hybrid cars to pay an annual fee to cover their share of the cost to repair roads, which could further depress sales of those models. PAGE B1

OPINION A26-27

Lydia Polgreen

PAGE A26



SPORTS B7-10

Going South to Play Ball

Justin Turner thought he would have an M.L.B. job this season, even at age 41. Instead, he is starring in Mexico, vowing to play as long as he can. PAGE B7



NATIONAL A12-23

Waiting for the Best Seller

It was a tough year for public libraries after a venerable distributor of print books went bankrupt. PAGE A12

Limits on PFAS to End

The Trump administration said it would drop some restrictions on “forever chemicals” in drinking water. PAGE A20

INTERNATIONAL A4-11

Backstory of Autocrats’ Minions

Research sheds light on how would-be authoritarians promote middling people, a.k.a. “loyal losers,” to do their dirty work. News Analysis. PAGE A4

Disaster on the Black Sea

Ukraine’s strikes on Russian refineries have brought pitch-black smoke, oil-laden rain and a large spill. PAGE A9

FOOD D1-6

A Fish With a Patriotic Flavor

Once celebrated as a Revolutionary War savior, shad has become a rarity. Fans still seek it out, though. PAGE D1



ARTS C1-6

Adding Dance to the Palette

The abstract painter Julie Mehretu and the choreographer John Jasperse are collaborating on an exhibition. PAGE C1

Struggles Behind the Stardom

Hayden Panettiere, 36, has lots of grief and trauma to fill her new memoir. But she has much to celebrate, too. PAGE C1